Transition Words & Phrases

Concept

Transitions show the relationship between ideas. Choose the relationship first, then choose the wording.

Bridge

Connects sentences or paragraphs so the reader can follow your thinking.

Logic first

Addition, contrast, sequence and cause are different relationships. A transition cannot repair a missing logical connection.

Punctuation

Use a comma after an opening transition: However, … . Between complete sentences, use a period or semicolon before however.

Reference bank

The following lists preserve the handout categories. Entries are options, not interchangeable synonyms; some need surrounding words.

Example 1 | original model

Choose a transition: The first plan is cheaper. The second plan lasts longer.

Solution / why it works

1. Relationship: contrast between cost and durability.
2. Revision: The first plan is cheaper; however, the second lasts longer.
3. Why it works: however signals the trade-off; the semicolon separates complete clauses.

Transition Words & Phrases

Word bank | Location / Space

above	beside	next to
across	between	of
adjacent	beyond	off
after	by	on top of
against	down	onto
ahead	from	opposite
along	in back of	outside
among	in front of	out of sight
around	including	over
at	inside	surrounding
at a distance	into	through
away from	in the background	throughout
before	in the foreground	towards
behind	near	under
below	nearby	upon
beneath	nearer	within

Word bank | Time / Sequence

about	at once	eventually
after	at the same time	finally
afterward	at the time	first
and then	at this point	first of all
as evidence	before	followed by
as soon as	before long	for a minute
at first	concurrently	for instance
at last	during	for now
at least	earlier	formerly

Transition Words & Phrases

Word bank | Time / Sequence (continued)

generally
immediately
in fact
in the meantime
in time
in turn
last
later
meanwhile
next
next week
once
ordinarily
previously
rarely
second
simultaneously
since
soon
subsequently
then
thereafter
third
till
to begin
to begin with
today
tomorrow
until
usually
when
while
yesterday

Word bank | Cause and Effect

accordingly
as a result of
because
because of
brought about
caused by
consequently
due to
for the reason
if...then
in effect
is responsible for
leads to
otherwise
since
so
so that
therefore
when
whenever

Word bank | Compare and Contrast

a variation
again
alike
also
although
an alternative
analogous to
another view
as
as opposed to
as seen
as well as
balanced against
both
but

Transition Words & Phrases

Word bank | Compare and Contrast (continued)

by comparison
compared to
contrasted with
contrasting
conversely
despite
differing from
discrepancy
disparity
distinction
equally
evaluate
even though
however
in a different way
in a similar way
in contrast
in like fashion
in like manner
in spite of
in the same way
like
likewise
match
nevertheless
nonetheless
nor can one ignore
on the contrary
on the other hand
one and the same
placed side by side
rather than
regardless
similar to
similarly
then again
though
uniquely
unlike
weigh against
where
whereas
whether or not
while
yet

Word bank | Introducing an Idea or Point

according to
accordingly
additionally
again
also
although
an added point
an alternative
and then
another
as a matter of fact
as much as possible
as well as
at the same time
besides
but
case in point
consequently
equally important
essentially
first
for example
for instance
for the purpose of
further
furthermore
ideally
in addition
in any event
in fact
in particular
in reality
in short

Transition Words & Phrases

Word bank | Introducing an Idea or Point (continued)

in this case
indeed
likewise
markedly
more importantly
moreover
must
namely
nevertheless
next
officially
on the contrary
on the other hand
one also can say
one could also add
one more
otherwise
particularly
primarily
proof of this
second
similarly
such
such as
technically
that is
then
then too
theoretically
therefore
third
this can be seen
thus
to be sure
to demonstrate
to demonstrate this
to illustrate
to this extent
to this extreme
to reveal
truly
undoubtedly
what's more
when
where
whereas
without doubt

Word bank | Summary or Conclusion

accordingly
after all
all in all
and so
as a result
as a result of
as noted
as shown
at last
briefly
concludes with
concluding
consequently
finally
to summarize
to this end
today
ultimately
without a doubt
for these reasons
for this reason
hence
in a word
in all
in brief
in conclusion
in other words
in short
in sum
in summary

Transition Words & Phrases

Word bank | Summary or Conclusion (continued)

in the end
in the final analysis
in view of that
in total
last
nevertheless
now
on the whole
on whole
summing up
summarizing
therefore
thus
to conclude
to sum up
totally

Transition Words & Phrases

Practice | your turn

1. Join: The library closed. We studied at home. Show cause and effect.

2. Join: One character seeks praise. The other avoids attention. Show contrast.

3. Write a bridge from a paragraph about cost to a paragraph about reliability.

Transition Words & Phrases

Sample answers | check after trying

Writing tasks can have more than one strong answer. Use these models and checks to review your work.

1

The library closed, so we studied at home.

2

One character seeks praise, whereas the other avoids attention.

3

Possible bridge: Cost matters at first, but reliability determines whether the purchase remains useful.

Source & editing note

27 - Transition Words & Phrases Reference List to Use in Writing - Over 300.pdf | 2 supplied pages.

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Exact repeated list entries were consolidated and obvious extraction/spelling errors repaired. Alternatives may differ in meaning, grammar or tone.

Compare & Contrast Essays

Concept

Explain meaningful similarities and differences between two subjects, then show why the comparison matters.

Compare / contrast

Compare = examine similarities; contrast = examine differences. Answer the exact prompt.

Fair criteria

Apply the same criteria to both subjects. Compare access with access, not access with popularity.

Thesis

Name both subjects, make a clear judgment or insight, and preview the main criteria.

Point-by-point

Each body paragraph compares A and B on one criterion. Useful for making connections explicit.

Block method

Discuss A, then B in the same order of criteria. Add explicit links back to A.

Beyond a list

Explain the significance of each similarity or difference. A comparison needs an argument, not two disconnected descriptions.

Compare & Contrast Essays

Example 1 | original model

Build a thesis comparing print and digital study notes.

Solution / why it works

1. Choose criteria: searchability, distraction and annotation.
2. Thesis: Although print and digital notes both organize learning, print supports distraction-free annotation, while digital notes make searching and revision easier.
3. This names both subjects and makes a balanced, specific comparison.

Example 2 | original model

Turn a comparison into analysis.

Solution / why it works

1. Point: Both formats allow annotation.
2. Evidence/example: A paper margin holds sketches; a digital page allows movable comments.
3. Analysis: The shared purpose is active reading, but the format changes how easily the annotations can be rearranged.

Compare & Contrast Essays

A point-by-point essay map

Introduction

Hook → context → thesis naming both subjects.

↓

Criterion 1

A + support → B + support → comparison and significance.

↓

Criterion 2

Repeat with a new criterion, keeping the comparison fair.

↓

Criterion 3

Develop another important similarity or difference if needed.

↓

Conclusion

Synthesize the comparison → return to thesis → explain why it matters.

Compare & Contrast Essays

Planner | compare before drafting

Subjects A and B; purpose of the comparison:

Criterion 1: evidence for A / evidence for B / insight:

Criterion 2: evidence for A / evidence for B / insight:

Criterion 3: evidence for A / evidence for B / insight:

Main comparison / working thesis:

Compare & Contrast Essays

Practice | your turn

1. Choose two study spaces and three fair comparison criteria.

2. Write a thesis that explains a meaningful similarity AND difference.

3. Draft one point-by-point paragraph with a concluding insight.

Compare & Contrast Essays

Sample answers | check after trying

Writing tasks can have more than one strong answer. Use these models and checks to review your work.

1

Possible criteria: noise, access to resources, seating. Apply all three to both places.

2

Possible thesis: The library and classroom offer useful study resources, but the library better supports independent reading while the classroom supports group feedback.

3

Check: topic sentence → evidence about A → evidence about B → explicit comparison → significance.

Source & editing note

Compare and Contrast Essay.pdf | 11 supplied pages.

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Essay Structure & Terms

Concept

An essay develops one main idea through connected paragraphs. The five-paragraph model is a planning scaffold; length depends on the task.

Title

A specific name that hints at the topic or argument.

Introduction

Opens the topic and leads the reader toward the thesis.

Grabber / hook

The opening sentence or two that creates interest.

Focus statement

Introduces the general topic and useful context.

Thesis

The essay's central claim or controlling idea.

Thesis support

A reason or subclaim used to plan a body paragraph.

Topic sentence

States a paragraph's main point and connects it to the thesis.

Body paragraph

Develops one main point using evidence and explanation.

Details

Facts, examples, observations or quotations that develop a point.

Essay Structure & Terms

Conclusion

Brings the argument together and explains its significance.

Modified focus / thesis

Revisits the topic and main claim in fresh wording after the evidence.

Challenge

A final thought, question or action that follows from the essay.

Bridge / flow

A bridge connects ideas; flow is their overall logical continuity.

Audience / purpose

Who will read the essay, and what the writing should achieve.

Formality / tone

Formality is the level of register; tone is the attitude expressed.

Organization / diction

Organization is the arrangement of ideas; diction is word choice.

Essay Structure & Terms

Example 1 | original model

From topic to paragraph

Solution / why it works

1. Topic: a quiet study room. Thesis: A quiet study room would give students a dependable place for focused work.

2. Topic sentence: A reserved room would reduce interruptions during independent reading.

3. Support: Describe a realistic interruption and explain how a quiet-space rule addresses it.

4. Closing: Link fewer interruptions to the thesis about dependable study conditions.

Essay Structure & Terms

Essay at a glance

Opening

Grabber → focus/context → thesis.

↓

Body

Topic sentence → evidence/details → explanation → closing link.

↓

Next body paragraph(s)

Develop the next reason with the same evidence-to-explanation logic.

↓

Conclusion

Return to the topic → synthesize the claim → final thought.

Essay Structure & Terms

Planner | from prompt to essay

Prompt / audience / purpose / tone:

Working title + hook + focus:

Thesis + two or three supporting reasons:

Evidence and explanation for each reason:

Conclusion / final thought:

Essay Structure & Terms

Submission checklist | from the handout

Page setup

The source calls for white Letter paper, one-inch margins, double spacing and left-aligned text.

Typography

It recommends a readable standard 12-point font and black text. These are essay-submission directions, separate from this notebook's requested appearance.

Heading and header

First-page heading: student, teacher, course and date. Running header: surname and page number at the top right, if assigned.

Paragraphs

Use a consistent first-line indent, normally half an inch; use paragraph settings rather than repeated spaces.

Final review

Check thesis, evidence, organization, transitions, grammar, spelling and punctuation. Follow your teacher's specific formatting requirements.

Essay Structure & Terms

Practice | your turn

1. Write a hook, focus statement and thesis for a school improvement.

2. Plan two body paragraphs with different reasons.

3. Write a conclusion that synthesizes rather than copies the introduction.

Essay Structure & Terms

Sample answers | check after trying

Writing tasks can have more than one strong answer. Use these models and checks to review your work.

1

Hook attracts interest; focus gives context; thesis states the specific claim.

2

Each paragraph needs a distinct reason, relevant support and an explanation.

3

Restate the insight in new words, connect the reasons and end with a proportionate final thought.

Source & editing note

Essay Structure and Terms.pdf | 8 supplied pages.

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Short Story & Novel Terms

Concept

Read a story through its events, characters, setting and patterns of meaning. Use terms to explain an effect, not just to label it.

Evidence → interpretation

Identify a detail, name the relevant technique, then explain how it shapes the reader's understanding.

Narrator ≠ author

The voice telling the story may have beliefs different from the writer's.

Topic ≠ theme

A topic is a subject such as friendship. A theme is an insight about that subject, supported by the text.

Flexible structures

Not every story follows a neat plot pyramid. An unresolved ending can be deliberate.

Short Story & Novel Terms

Example 1 | original model

Original mini-story: Jo hides a broken trophy, then admits what happened when a teammate is blamed.

Solution / why it works

1. Conflict: Jo's fear of punishment struggles against her sense of fairness.
2. Character: Her admission suggests a dynamic change if the story shows a meaningful shift in her values.
3. Possible theme: Taking responsibility can require risking one's own reputation.
4. Evidence matters: the theme follows from her choice; "honesty" alone is only a topic.

Short Story & Novel Terms

Reference | Plot & structure

Short story / novel

Both are fictional narratives. A novel usually allows greater length and complexity; a short story is more concentrated.

Plot

The arrangement of events and actions in a narrative.

Introduction / exposition

Establishes relevant characters, setting and background.

Initiating incident

The event that sets the central action or conflict in motion.

Rising action

Complications develop and pressure grows.

Climax

A major turning point or peak of tension in the central conflict.

Falling action

Consequences of the climax begin to unfold.

Dénouement / resolution

The closing stage; some stories resolve their conflicts, while others leave questions open.

Expository happy / sad ending

The handout's labels for explained, closed endings with happy or sad outcomes.

Short Story & Novel Terms

Surprise / twist ending

An unexpected development changes the reader's understanding.

Unresolved / indeterminate ending

Some questions remain open; a cliffhanger leaves urgent uncertainty.

Anticlimax

A drop from expected importance or intensity, sometimes deliberately comic.

Chronological order

Events appear in the order in which they occur.

In medias res

The story begins in the middle of the action.

Flashback

Narration moves back to an earlier event.

Foreshadowing

Details hint at developments that will come later.

Suspense

Uncertainty creates anticipation, concern or tension.

Deus ex machina

An unprepared external intervention conveniently resolves a conflict.

Short Story & Novel Terms

Reference | Characters & characterization

Character

A person, animal or other represented being in a story.

Characterization

The methods used to develop and reveal a character, not merely the cast list.

Protagonist

The central character; not necessarily morally good.

Antagonist

A character or force opposing the protagonist; not necessarily a villain.

Flat / round

Flat: few developed traits. Round: complex, multi-sided characterization.

Dynamic / static

Dynamic (kinetic): changes meaningfully. Static: remains substantially unchanged.

Stock / stereotypical

A familiar type built from conventional traits; can become a cliché.

Cliché

An overused expression, device or idea.

Foil

A contrasting character who helps reveal another's qualities.

Short Story & Novel Terms

Caricature

Exaggerated traits, often for comic or critical effect.

Hero / anti-hero

A hero displays admired qualities; an anti-hero lacks some conventional heroic qualities.

Direct presentation

The narrator explicitly states a trait: "Leah was patient."

Indirect presentation

A trait is inferred from action, speech, thought, appearance or others' reactions.

Character analysis

Use appearance, speech, actions, thoughts, others' comments and narrator information as clues.

Character sketch

A supported description of personality and values, with specific textual evidence.

Epiphany

A sudden realization that changes understanding.

Dilemma

A difficult choice between alternatives with competing costs.

Short Story & Novel Terms

Reference | Setting, theme & conflict

Setting

Time, place and social context of the story.

Mood / atmosphere

The emotional quality created through details, events and language.

Theme

An interpretation of the story's insight into people or life; express it as a supported statement.

Topic / moral

Topic: the subject. Moral: a lesson about conduct. A theme need not give advice.

Conflict

A struggle between opposing desires, forces or values.

Internal conflict

A struggle within a character, such as loyalty versus fear.

External conflict

A struggle with an outside force; other characters need not know about it.

Conflict patterns

Person vs person, self, nature/environment, society, technology/machine or supernatural forces.

Universal / personal / cultural symbols

Widely recognized, privately meaningful or associated with a particular culture; meanings still depend on context.

Short Story & Novel Terms

Reference | Narration, style & irony

Narration / narrator

Narration is the act or result of telling; the narrator is the voice doing the telling.

Point of view

The perspective and access to information through which a story is told.

First person

An "I" narrator participates in or observes events; need not be the protagonist.

Second person

The narrative addresses a "you."

Third-person omniscient

An outside narrator can know multiple characters' thoughts and wider events.

Third-person limited

Access is restricted to one character at a time; also called limited omniscient in the handout.

Objective narration

Reports observable actions and speech without directly revealing thoughts.

Style / stylistic technique

Characteristic choices in diction, syntax, imagery and narrative method.

Dialect

A language variety with patterns of vocabulary, grammar and pronunciation.

Short Story & Novel Terms

Diction

Word choice. Syntax is the arrangement of words and clauses.

Antithesis

Contrasting ideas in a balanced structure.

Verbal irony

The intended meaning differs from the literal wording, often oppositely.

Situational irony

An outcome meaningfully contradicts an expectation.

Dramatic irony

Readers or viewers know something a character does not.

Paradox

An apparent contradiction that may reveal a truth.

Sarcasm

Cutting or mocking language, often using verbal irony.

Satire

Humour, irony or exaggeration used to criticize behaviour or institutions.

Horatian / Juvenalian satire

Gentler, amused criticism / harsher, indignant criticism.

Stream of consciousness

Writing follows the flow of perceptions, thoughts and associations.

Short Story & Novel Terms

Symbol / symbolism

Something has significance beyond its literal role; symbolism is the use or pattern of such meanings.

Short Story & Novel Terms

Reference | Forms of fiction

Allegory

A narrative whose characters and events sustain another level of meaning.

Legend

A traditional account linked to a person, place or purported historical past.

Myth

A culturally significant traditional narrative about origins, powers or beliefs; not simply a synonym for falsehood.

Fable

A brief narrative, often with animal characters, that conveys a moral.

Proverb

A short traditional saying expressing advice or a general observation.

Folk tale

A traditional story transmitted within a community orally or in writing.

Graphic text / graphic novel

Meaning develops through sequential images and words, including their contrasts.

Mystery

A narrative organized around investigating an unexplained event.

Science fiction / fantasy

Speculative science or technology / imagined worlds or supernatural possibilities.

Short Story & Novel Terms

Romance / historical / contemporary

Love-centred narrative / a past setting / a broadly present-day setting.

Word bank | Theme topic prompts

Abandonment	Grief	Pride
Alienation	Growth and initiation	Race
Ambition	Guilt	Regret
American Dream	Heroism	Rejection
Birth/Childhood	Hope	Religion
Coming of Age	Human relations	Responsibility
Commoditization	Identity	Revenge
Commercialism	Illness	Sacrifice
Commerce	Individual & Nature	Science & Technology
Community	Individual & Society	Sex & Sensuality
Cruelty	Individual & God	Social Class
Death	Innocence	Spirituality
Education	Isolation	Stages of Life
Ethics	Journey & Struggle	Success
Experience	Justice	Suffering
Fall from Grace	Love & Friendship	Survival
Family	Memory	Time
Fate	Nationalism	Tradition
Freedom	Nature	Violence
Futility	Oppression	Work
Gender	Parenthood	

Short Story & Novel Terms

Word bank | Recurring narrative patterns

Struggle with nature	Life and death	Chance and fate
Pressure from society	Sacrifice and reward	Revenge
Questions of divinity	Shared human needs	A trick
Crime and consequences	A journey	A mystery
Overcoming adversity	Loss of innocence	Identity and belonging
Friendship and sacrifice	Noble sacrifice	Technology and nature
Family bonds	A great battle	Free will and responsibility
Opposing forces / balance	Fall from grace	
Pursuit of love	Love and friendship	

Short Story & Novel Terms

Practice | your turn

1. Identify the protagonist, conflict and turning point in a story you know.

2. Explain how a character can be round but static.

3. Write a theme statement and support it with two details.

4. Distinguish dramatic irony from a surprising ending.

Short Story & Novel Terms

Sample answers | check after trying

Writing tasks can have more than one strong answer. Use these models and checks to review your work.

1

The protagonist is central to the action; the conflict is the struggle; the turning point changes its direction.

2

Round concerns complexity; static concerns change. A complex character may retain the same values.

3

A theme is a full insight, not a one-word topic or a claim about every person.

4

Dramatic irony involves an audience knowledge gap; a surprise ending changes expectations.

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Grade 12 Short Story and Novel Terms.pdf | 11 supplied pages.

No author identified in the supplied handout. Concepts reorganized and condensed; repeated templates consolidated. Examples, practice and sample answers here are original additions, not copied student work.

Historical exam asterisks and "new term" markers were omitted; they do not establish current course or exam requirements. Definitions were clarified where the handout oversimplified them.

Poetry Terms

Concept

Poetry makes meaning through language, sound, rhythm and form. Read aloud, notice patterns, then connect them to an interpretation.

Speaker ≠ poet

The poem's speaking voice may be a created persona.

Sound + meaning

Name the sound pattern and explain its effect in this poem; no sound has one fixed emotion.

Form + meaning

Line breaks, stanza lengths and repetition affect pace and emphasis.

Read in layers

Literal situation → striking details → patterns → possible meaning.

Poetry Terms

Example 1 | original model

Original lines: "The tired gate complained / as evening slipped inside."

Solution / why it works

1. Device: personification gives the gate a human action, "complained."
2. Imagery: the gate's sound suggests a creak; evening entering creates a visual scene.
3. Possible effect: tired and complained make the setting feel worn and weary.
4. Avoid overclaiming: the two lines suggest a mood; they do not establish the poet's personal feelings.

Example 2 | original model

Read this rhyme pattern: "We watched the pale and fading light / The river carried leaves away / A lantern trembled in the night / Then darkness folded up the day."

Solution / why it works

1. End words: light / away / night / day.
2. Assign matching sounds: A / B / A / B.
3. This four-line stanza is a quatrain with an ABAB rhyme scheme.

Poetry Terms

Reference | Poem types

Poem

Language organized for concentrated effects of meaning, sound, rhythm or visual form.

Speaker

The voice within a poem; do not automatically identify it with the poet.

Ballad

A narrative poem or song, often using repetition and a regular stanza pattern; it need not be tragic.

Concrete poetry

The arrangement of letters and words contributes visually to meaning.

Dramatic monologue

A single speaker reveals character and situation while addressing an implied listener.

Elegy

A poem of mourning, loss or remembrance.

Epic

An extended narrative poem, often about consequential actions or a community's history.

Epitaph

A short inscription or poem commemorating someone who has died.

Poetry Terms

Epigram

A brief, pointed, often witty statement or poem.

Free verse

Poetry without a required regular metrical or rhyme scheme; patterns may still occur.

Lyric

Usually a relatively short poem expressing perception, thought or feeling.

Narrative poem

A poem that tells a story.

Parody

An imitation of another work or style for comic or critical effect.

Pastoral

Writing that represents rural life, often in an idealized way.

Sonnet

Traditionally a 14-line poem; English sonnets commonly use iambic pentameter and structured rhyme.

Ode

A lyric that addresses, celebrates or thoughtfully considers a subject.

Poetry Terms

Reference | Sound

Alliteration

Repetition of initial consonant sounds in nearby words: wild winter winds.

Assonance

Repetition of vowel sounds in nearby words: slow road home.

Consonance

Repetition of consonant sounds, not restricted to word beginnings or middles: blank and think share /nk/.

Cacophony

A harsh or jarring combination of sounds; the effect depends on context.

Dissonance

Discordant or clashing sounds that disturb smoothness.

Euphony

A pleasing or flowing combination of sounds.

Onomatopoeia

A word imitates a sound: hiss, buzz or clang. Also called imitative harmony.

Poetry Terms

Reference | Comparison & figurative language

Metaphor

A non-literal comparison that presents one thing as another: the city is a maze.

Extended metaphor

A comparison developed over several lines or a whole work.

Simile

A comparison using like or as: the street curled like a ribbon.

Personification

Human qualities given to something non-human: the window sighed.

Metonymy

A related thing stands for another: the crown for royal authority.

Synecdoche

A part stands for the whole, or the whole for a part: hands for workers.

Figurative / literal language

Figurative meaning goes beyond ordinary literal sense; literal wording states what it directly means.

Hyperbole / understatement

Deliberate exaggeration / deliberate reduction of apparent importance.

Oxymoron

Seemingly contradictory terms placed together: deafening silence.

Poetry Terms

Paradox

An apparently contradictory statement that invites a deeper interpretation; not merely a longer oxymoron.

Poetry Terms

Reference | Word choice & meaning

Allusion

A reference to another work, person, event, place or tradition.

Apostrophe

Direct address to an absent person, an abstraction or something non-human.

Cliché

An expression or idea weakened by overuse.

Connotation / denotation

Associated feelings or ideas / the direct dictionary meaning.

Euphemism

A milder or indirect expression replaces a harsh or uncomfortable one.

Idiom

An established expression whose meaning is not simply the literal meaning of its words.

Image / imagery

A sensory detail / the use or pattern of sensory details, involving any of the five senses.

Mood

The atmosphere or feeling the poem creates.

Tone

The speaker's attitude toward the subject or audience.

Poetry Terms

Voice

The distinctive personality or qualities of the speaking or writing style.

Symbol

Something signifies beyond itself; establish that meaning through context.

Repetition

Deliberately repeated sounds, words, phrases or lines.

Syntax

The arrangement of words, phrases and clauses.

Poetry Terms

Reference | Verse forms, metre & rhyme

Stanza / verse paragraph

A group of lines functioning as a unit; rhyme is not required.

Couplet / quatrain

A pair of lines / a four-line stanza; often rhymed, but not necessarily.

Sestet / octave

A six-line unit / an eight-line unit, especially parts of a sonnet.

Ballad stanza

Often four lines alternating four and three metrical feet, with ABCB or ABAB rhyme. Variations occur.

Blank verse

Unrhymed metrical verse, typically iambic pentameter. A rhyming sonnet is not blank verse.

Rhythm / metre

Rhythm is the movement of sound; metre is an organizing pattern of stresses.

Iamb

A metrical foot with an unstressed then stressed syllable: de-LIGHT.

Iambic pentameter

Five iambic feet per line; ten syllables is typical, but actual lines can vary.

Trimeter / tetrameter

Three / four metrical feet per line.

Poetry Terms

Other metre lengths

Dimeter: 2; pentameter: 5; hexameter: 6; heptameter: 7; octameter: 8 feet.

Rhyme

Correspondence of sounds, usually from the last stressed vowel onward.

End rhyme / internal rhyme

Rhyme at line endings / rhyme within a line.

Rhyme scheme

Letters mark matching end sounds, starting with A.

Refrain

A repeated line or group of lines.

English sonnet pattern

ABAB CDCD EFEF GG: three quatrains and a closing couplet.

Petrarchan sonnet pattern

An octave, often ABBAABBA, followed by a sestet such as CDECDE or CDCDCD.

Poetry Terms

Quick checks | avoid common mix-ups

Blank verse ≠ sonnet

Blank verse does not rhyme. Traditional sonnets have rhyme schemes. The original handout incorrectly groups all sonnets with blank verse.

Stanza size ≠ rhyme

Couplet, quatrain, sestet and octave identify line groupings; these groupings do not always have to rhyme.

Consonance

Repeated consonant sounds can occur in different word positions, not only the middle.

Poem types can overlap

A poem can be both lyric and elegy, or narrative and ballad. The original decision tree is a rough classroom guide, not an exhaustive classification.

Interpretation needs evidence

Identify the speaker's situation and the details supporting your reading. A title or one word alone may not settle the meaning.

Poetry Terms

Practice | your turn

1. Name the device: "The wind whispered through the wire." Explain two possible sound patterns.

2. Write a two-line metaphor and extend the same comparison in a third line.

3. Explain the difference between blank verse and free verse.

4. Write a tone word and a mood word for a poem, then justify each with a detail.

Poetry Terms

Sample answers | check after trying

Writing tasks can have more than one strong answer. Use these models and checks to review your work.

1

Personification: wind whispers. Alliteration: repeated initial /w/ sounds in wind, whispered and wire.

2

Keep the comparison coherent. Example: The city is a notebook; its streets are lines; each traveller leaves a sentence.

3

Blank verse has metre (usually iambic pentameter) without rhyme. Free verse has no required regular metrical or rhyme scheme.

4

Tone describes the speaker's attitude; mood describes the atmosphere or feeling created.

Poetry Terms

Source & editing note

Poetry 12 Terms1.pdf | 8 supplied pages.

No author identified in the supplied handout. Concepts reorganized and condensed; repeated templates consolidated. Examples, practice and sample answers here are original additions, not copied student work.

Historical exam asterisks and "new term" markers were omitted; they do not establish current course or exam requirements. Definitions were clarified where the handout oversimplified them.

Definition check: Academy of American Poets | blank verse

Definition check: Poetry Foundation | sonnet

Reflective Essays

Concept

Reflective writing connects a personal experience to a change in understanding. The event matters because of what you make of it.

Purpose

Show how an experience shaped your perspective, choices or understanding.

First person

I, me and my are appropriate when the task asks for personal reflection.

Reflective thesis

Introduce the experience and the learning or change that gives it meaning.

Show and reflect

Use a few concrete details, actions or dialogue; then explain why they matter.

Effect structure

What happened → result → effect on you.

Story structure

First → next / obstacle → last / learning.

Analysis structure

Experience → personal effect → deeper meaning.

Flexible length

Use the structure that serves the experience. Five paragraphs are a starting scaffold, not a universal rule.

Reflective Essays

Example 1 | original model

Revise a vague reflective thesis.

Solution / why it works

1. Before: I learned a lot from our group project.

2. After: Missing our first group deadline taught me that asking for help early is part of being reliable.

3. The revision names the event, the change in thinking and its significance.

Example 2 | original model

Add reflection to a scene.

Solution / why it works

1. Scene: I stared at the unfinished slides while the group chat filled with questions.

2. Reflection: I had treated silence as proof that I could manage alone; now I saw that it kept my teammates from helping.

3. The reflection explains the belief behind the action instead of only retelling it.

Reflective Essays

Planner | event → meaning

Experience and context (who / where / when):

What I thought before:

Key moment, obstacle or turning point:

What happened as a result:

What I understand now, and why:

How this learning will affect a future choice:

Reflective Essays

Practice | your turn

1. Choose one small experience that changed your thinking. State the belief before and after.

2. Write a three-sentence scene using two sensory details or one line of dialogue.

3. Follow the scene with two sentences explaining its significance and a future action.

Reflective Essays

Sample answers | check after trying

Writing tasks can have more than one strong answer. Use these models and checks to review your work.

1

Use a genuine, specific change rather than a generic "I grew as a person."

2

Sensory details should clarify the experience; dialogue should be purposeful and honestly represented.

3

Possible pattern: I once believed … . This showed me … . Next time I will … .

Source & editing note

Reflective Essay.pdf | 16 supplied pages.

Source credited to Simply Novel in the supplied PDF. Concepts reorganized and condensed; repeated templates consolidated. Examples, practice and sample answers here are original additions, not copied student work.

Response to Literature

Concept

A literary response makes an interpretation and supports it with details from the text. Explain how the writing creates meaning.

Read the prompt

Identify the text, the literary feature and every part of the question.

Thesis

Name the text(s), identify the focus and state a defensible interpretation.

Evidence

Choose a concise quotation, paraphrase or summary that directly supports the claim.

Analysis

Explain how specific words, actions or patterns support your interpretation.

SEAT

Statement → Evidence → Analysis → Transition. Use it as a flexible paragraph guide.

Summary vs paraphrase

Summary condenses main ideas. Paraphrase restates a specific passage in your own wording and sentence structure.

Attribution

Credit borrowed ideas as well as exact quotations. A quotation needs accurate wording and an identifiable source.

Response to Literature

Organization

One claim with several reasons, or several connected subclaims under one thesis.

Example 1 | original model

Analyze this invented micro-text: “Mara folded the apology twice, then left it beneath the locked door.”

Solution / why it works

1. Statement: Mara wants to repair the relationship but fears a direct conversation.
2. Evidence: She leaves the apology “beneath the locked door.”
3. Analysis: The door separates the characters physically, while the indirect delivery suggests hesitation rather than open dialogue.
4. Transition: Her next action could show whether she overcomes that hesitation. This is a possible interpretation, not the only one.

Response to Literature

Example 2 | original model

Improve a weak analysis.

Solution / why it works

1. Weak: The door is locked. This proves my point.

2. Stronger: The locked door makes reconciliation difficult; leaving a note allows Mara to reach out while avoiding an immediate response.

3. The stronger version links a precise detail to the interpretation.

Response to Literature

Textual evidence | quick reference

Choose evidence

Record exact wording, context, author/title and a real page or line locator. Select the shortest useful passage.

Build the paragraph

Introduce the claim → integrate evidence → explain its meaning → connect to the next idea.

Paraphrase honestly

Change both wording and structure while preserving meaning. A paraphrase still needs attribution.

Author-page pattern

For a paginated source: "quoted words" (Surname 42). If the author is already named in the sentence, use (42).

Keep the source clear

Omit a repeated name only when the source is unmistakable. For multiple works by one author, add a shortened title as needed.

Short-quote punctuation

The closing quotation mark precedes the citation, and the sentence period follows it. A quoted question mark remains inside the quotation.

Lead-ins

A signal phrase may take a comma; a complete introductory clause can take a colon. A quote blended into your grammar may need neither.

Response to Literature

Omissions and changes

Use ellipses for omitted words and brackets for necessary additions; do not alter the original meaning.

Titles

Italicize longer independent works such as novels; use quotation marks for short stories and short poems. Handwritten work may underline long-work titles when assigned.

Works Cited

In-text references point to full source entries. Credit quotes, paraphrases and summaries; follow the assigned style.

The author name and page 42 above are placeholders demonstrating citation structure, not a real quotation or source.

Response to Literature

Evidence organizer

Working thesis / aspect of the text:

Claim 1 + exact evidence + source location:

Context + what the wording reveals:

Claim 2 + exact evidence + source location:

How the evidence supports the thesis:

Response to Literature

Literary analysis | term refresher

Plot

Exposition introduces context; rising action develops complications; climax turns the action; falling action shows consequences; resolution closes or leaves questions.

Conflict / character

Internal struggle occurs within a character; external struggle involves an outside force. A protagonist faces opposition; a foil highlights traits through contrast.

Setting / theme

Setting includes place, time and social context. Theme is a supported insight about the work's subject.

Point of view

First person uses I. Third-person limited restricts access; omniscient narration can range across minds. The narrator is not automatically the author.

Diction / symbolism

Diction is word choice. Symbolism gives details significance beyond their literal role.

Irony

Verbal: meaning differs from words. Situational: outcome contradicts expectation. Dramatic: audience knows more than a character.

Figurative language

Metaphor identifies one thing with another; simile compares using like/as; personification gives human qualities to non-human things.

Response to Literature

Emphasis and atmosphere

Hyperbole exaggerates; understatement minimizes. Tone is attitude; mood is the feeling created.

Time devices

Foreshadowing hints at later developments; flashback presents an earlier event.

Response to Literature

Practice | your turn

1. Using the invented micro-text above, write another defensible interpretation.

2. Select a quotation from your current class text. Record its exact words, context and location.

3. Write one SEAT paragraph. Underline the sentence that explains how the evidence supports your claim.

Response to Literature

Sample answers | check after trying

Writing tasks can have more than one strong answer. Use these models and checks to review your work.

1

Possible interpretation: Mara acts with persistence because she finds a way to deliver the apology despite the barrier.

2

Keep author/title and page, line or other real locator. Never invent a page number.

3

Check: claim is arguable; evidence is relevant; explanation goes beyond restating the quote; transition follows logically.

Source & editing note

Response to Literature Notes.pdf | 24 supplied pages.

Source credited to Simply Novel in the supplied PDF. Concepts reorganized and condensed; repeated templates consolidated. Examples, practice and sample answers here are original additions, not copied student work.

Citation check: Purdue OWL | MLA in-text citations

Citation check: Purdue OWL | formatting quotations

Sensory & Colour Word Banks

Concept

Use precise sensory details to help a reader imagine a scene. Select a few meaningful details instead of piling on adjectives.

Five senses

Sight, sound, touch, taste and smell create different routes into a scene.

Specific detail

Choose the detail that reveals setting, action or mood.

Colour + meaning

A colour word suggests shade and sometimes texture or association. Check the actual meaning before substituting.

Context matters

The supplied banks include nouns, adjectives and verbs. They are descriptive options, not universal synonyms.

Example 1 | original model

Revise: The kitchen was nice.

Solution / why it works

1. Choose the intended mood: warm and welcoming.
2. Revision: Amber light spread across the table, and the scent of toasted bread drifted from the oven.
3. Sight and smell support the mood without naming every sense.

Sensory & Colour Word Banks

Word bank | Sound

blaring	lilting	scream
boisterous	low	screech
booming	mellow	shrill
brassy	mellifluous	silent
buzz	melodic	slam
caterwaul	monotonous	snap
chime	muffled	squawk
clink	musical	squeak
crackle	muted	squeal
crunch	noiseless	staccato
deafening	noisy	thump
dulcet	patter	thunderous
earsplitting	peep	tinkle
explosive	piercing	unspoken
grinding	popping	wail
gurgle	pulsating	wheezing
hiss	raucous	whine
honking	resounding	whispered
howling	rhythmic	whistle
hum	riotous	yelp
hushed	roaring	yowl
jingle	rumbling	

Sensory & Colour Word Banks

Word bank | Sight

ancient	drab	indistinct
angular	dramatic	insipid
animated	elegant	irregular
arrogant	energetic	irresistible
attractive	exhausted	jammed
awkward	exotic	lavish
beefy	faded	leafy
bleary	feathery	lively
blotched	feeble	loose
blurry	flashy	massive
bold	flat	miniature
bright	flimsy	misty
brilliant	fluffy	muddled
broken	flush	muddy
bruised	formal	murky
bulky	frail	muscular
chaotic	frightened	opulent
cheap	frilled	orderly
cluttered	gaudy	painted
colored	glassy	peaceful
colorless	glistening	placid
congested	gloomy	pristine
crinkled	glossy	radiant
curved	glowing	ramshackle
dazzling	grassy	regal
delicate	handsome	rigid
dim	hazy	robust
dingy	hefty	ruffled

Sensory & Colour Word Banks

Word bank | Sight (continued)

shabby
shadowy
shapely
sheer
shimmering
shiny
sickly
slender
smudged
sparkling
sparkly
speckled
spongy
spotted
sprinkled
stout
streaked
stretched
striped
sturdy
sunny
supple
swarming
swollen
tangled
tantalizing
tidy
timid
tinted
tranquil
vibrant
vivid
wavy
waxy
weightless
weighty
wild
wiry
worn
wrecked
wrinkled

Word bank | Touch

abrasive
arid
balmy
blistering
boiling
breezy
bristly
bumpy
burning
chafing
chilly
clammy
coarse
cool
crisp
cushioned
damp
dehydrated
dense
dried
dull
dusty
elastic
feathery
fleshy
fluffy
fragile
freezing
fresh
frosty
furry
fuzzy
gluey
greasy
gritty
hairy

Sensory & Colour Word Banks

Word bank | Touch (continued)

heavy
icy
itchy
jagged
leathery
lukewarm
moist
mushy
oily
plastic
prickly
rubbery
sandy
satiny
scalding
scorching
searing
sharp
silky
sizzling
slight
slimy
slippery
spiky
spongy
steamy
sticky
stocky
tender
tepid
thick
tough
velvety
waxy

Word bank | Taste

acidic
bitter
bittersweet
bland
briny
burnt
buttery
citrusy
creamy
crisp
fatty
fiery
fishy
fresh
fruity
full-bodied
gristly
greasy
hearty
herbal
insipid
juicy
leathery
lemony
metallic
mild
nasty
nutty
oily
peppery
piquant
pungent
rancid
raw
refreshing
rich
robust
rotten
salty
savory
sharp
smoky

Sensory & Colour Word Banks

Word bank | Taste (continued)

sour
spicy
stale
stinging
sugared
sugary
sweet
syrupy
tangy
tart
toasty
understated
unpalatable
vinegary
woody
yeasty
zesty

Word bank | Smell

acrid
aromatic
balmy
bouquet
briny
burnt
cedar
clean
coppery
delicate
earthy
faint
fetid
fishy
floral
flowery
foul
fragrant
fresh
fruity
funky
gamy
gaseous
heady
intoxicating
malodorous
medicinal
methane
mild
minty
moldy
musty
odorless
odorous
off
offensive
overpowering
perfumed
piney
potent
pungent
putrid
putrescent
rancid
rank
reeking
repugnant
ripe
robust
rosy
rotten
savory
scented
sharp
skunky
smelly
smoky
sour
spoiled
stagnant

Sensory & Colour Word Banks

Word bank | Smell (continued)

stale
stench
stinky
stuffy
sulphuric
sweet
tempting
unsavory
unscented
woody

Word bank | Red

blood
bloodshot
blush
burgundy
cardinal
carmine
cherry
coral
crimson
damask
garnet
pink
rose
ruby
ruddy
salmon
sanguine
scarlet
tomato

Word bank | Orange

amber
apricot
bourbon
carnelian
copper
coral
dayglo
fire
gold
mango
marigold
papaya
peach
persimmon
pumpkin
rust
tangerine
tawny
titian

Sensory & Colour Word Banks

Word bank | Yellow

blond
buff
butterscotch
canary
champagne
cream
dandelion
eggshell
gold
golden
goldenrod
honey
lemon
maize
mustard
ocher
saffron
straw
topaz

Word bank | Green

apple
army
avocado
chartreuse
emerald
fern
forest
holly
jade
kelly
leaf
lime
mint
olive
pine
reseda
sea foam

Word bank | Blue

aqua
aquamarine
azure
baby
bice
blueberry
cerulean
cobalt
cyan
heather
ice
indigo
midnight
navy
robin's egg
royal
sapphire
teal
turquoise

Sensory & Colour Word Banks

Word bank | Purple

amethyst
aubergine
blackberry
brandywine
byzantium
cerise
eggplant
fuchsia
grape
heliotrope
iris
lavender
lilac
magenta
maroon
mauve
orchid
periwinkle
plum
raisin
violet
wisteria

Word bank | Brown

auburn
beige
bronze
brunette
burnt sienna
caramel
chestnut
chocolate
cinnamon
cocoa
coffee
drab
fawn
ginger
hazel
khaki
mahogany
nut
sepia
tawny
toast
umber

Word bank | White

alabaster
antique
arctic
ashen
birch
blanched
bloodless
chalky
cotton
cream
fair
frosted
ghostly
ivory
lace
pale
pallid
pasty
pearl
pearly
sickly

Sensory & Colour Word Banks

Word bank | White (continued)

snowy

Word bank | Black

abyss
blackout
carbon
chalkboard
charcoal
coal
dark
darkness
ebony
jet
licorice
mica
midnight
molasses
obsidian
onyx
pitch
raven
sable
shadow
slate
sooty

Word bank | Other colours & patterns

achromatic
buff
checkered
freckled
heather
hounds-tooth
iridescent
matte
mottled
natural
nude
opaque
polka-dotted
psychedelic
rainbow
silver
sparkly
speckled
spotted
stained
striped
transparent

Sensory & Colour Word Banks

Practice | your turn

1. Describe a rainy bus stop in two sentences using sound and touch.

2. Describe the same room twice: once welcoming, once unsettling. Change three details.

3. Choose an unfamiliar colour word from the bank. Check its meaning and use it accurately.

Sensory & Colour Word Banks

Sample answers | check after trying

Writing tasks can have more than one strong answer. Use these models and checks to review your work.

1

Possible detail: Rain tapped the shelter roof; cold water seeped through my sleeve.

2

Welcoming: warm light, soft cushions, fresh bread. Unsettling: dim light, clammy fabric, stale air.

3

Check both the shade and the grammar. "An azure sky" works; colour names are not interchangeable.

Source & editing note

Sensory and Color Synonyms Words List to enhance writing.pdf | 3 supplied pages.

Source credited to Simply Novel in the supplied PDF. Concepts reorganized and condensed; repeated templates consolidated. Examples, practice and sample answers here are original additions, not copied student work.

The unclear source entry "velve" was omitted from the taste bank. Word categories reflect the supplied list; choose according to context.

Using Appropriate Tone

Concept

Tone is the attitude your wording conveys. Match the level of formality to your audience, purpose and situation.

Audience

A friend, teacher and formal public audience may expect different registers.

Purpose

A request, reflection and argument call for different choices.

Register

The handout uses five levels: very informal, informal, formal, more formal and highly formal.

Precision

Formal writing can still be clear and direct. Long words do not automatically improve tone.

Consistency

Keep slang, contractions, sentence patterns and address appropriate to the task.

Using Appropriate Tone

Example 1 | original model

Revise for a teacher: “Hey, send me that thing ASAP.”

Solution / why it works

1. Identify the problem: vague wording and a demanding tone.

2. Revision: Could you please send me the assignment rubric before tomorrow’s class?

3. The revision names the item, states a useful time and makes a respectful request.

Using Appropriate Tone

Tone scale | adapted from the handout

1

Very informal|A casual exchange with close friends; shared slang may be understood.

2

Informal|Familiar conversation, such as with a parent or guardian.

3

Formal|Clear, respectful language, such as an academic exchange with a teacher.

4

More formal|A carefully worded request to a principal or employer.

5

Highly formal|A formal academic, ceremonial or professional setting.

Use judgment

These are the source's illustrative levels, not fixed rules for every relationship. Consider the actual task and context.

Using Appropriate Tone

Practice | your turn

1. Rewrite "That plan is dumb" as a respectful disagreement for a class discussion.

2. Write a request for the same missing file to a friend and to a teacher.

3. Identify three choices that changed the tone.

Using Appropriate Tone

Sample answers | check after trying

Writing tasks can have more than one strong answer. Use these models and checks to review your work.

1

I disagree with the plan because it does not explain how the equipment will be shared.

2

Friend: Can you send me the notes? Teacher: Could you please share the notes from Monday's lesson?

3

Look at vocabulary, politeness, detail, contractions and directness.

Source & editing note

Use Appropriate Tone.pdf | 1 supplied pages.

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Vivid Verbs

Concept

Choose verbs that name the action precisely. A strong verb helps the reader see movement, intention or reasoning.

Precision over decoration

Strolled, sprinted and staggered all describe movement, but imply different speed or condition.

Meaning first

Substitute only when the new verb expresses the intended action.

Tense and grammar

Keep tense consistent and check whether the verb needs an object or a preposition.

Academic verbs

Analyzes, suggests, contrasts and demonstrates describe different analytical actions.

Reference bank

Alphabetical inventory from the supplied handout. Repeated entries are consolidated; mixed tense forms are retained.

Vivid Verbs

Example 1 | original model

Revise: She went across the room quickly.

Solution / why it works

1. Ask how she moved: urgently, playfully or awkwardly?
2. Urgent: She dashed across the room.
3. Awkward: She stumbled across the room.
4. These versions change the meaning; choose the one supported by the scene.

Word bank | A

abandon	achieve	affect
abduct	acknowledge	agonize
abolish	acquire	agree
abscond	act	agreed
absorb	activate	aid
abuse	adapt	aim
accelerate	add	alarm
accept	address	align
access	adjust	allege
accommodate	administer	alleviate
accomplish	admit	allocate
accost	admonish	allow
account for	advance	alter
accrue	advertise	amble
accumulate	advise	amend
accuse	advocate	amplify

Vivid Verbs

Word bank | A (continued)

amuse
analyze
annihilate
announce
answer
anticipate
appear
apply
appoint
appraise
appreciate
apprehend
approach
approve
approximate
arbitrate
argue
arise
arrange
arrest
articulate
ascend
ascertain
assault
assemble
assent
assert
assess
assign
assist
associate
assume
assure
attack
attain
attend
attract
attribute
audit
augment
author
authorize
automate
avert
avoid
avow
awaken
award

Word bank | B

babble
baffle
bang
bank
banter
bar
bark
bargain
barrel
bawl
beam
beat
beg
began
begin
behave
believe
bellow
benefit
bequeath
berate
bereave
bestow
bind
bite
blame
blast
block
blot
blow

Vivid Verbs

Word bank | B (continued)

blur
boast
bolster
bolt
bombard
bond
boogie
boost
bound
brag
brandish
break
breed
bribe
brief
broaden
buck
budge
budget
bug out
build
bully
bump
burrow
bury
bushwhack

Word bank | C

cackle
cajole
calculate
calibrate
canter
canvass
capitalize
capture
care
careen
carry
catalog
catapult
catch
categorize
cater
cause
cede
center
centralize
chair
challenge
chant
characterize
charge
charm
chart
chase
chastise
chatter
check
choke
choose
chuck
circle
circulate
claim
clamor
clarify
clash
classify
climb
clinch
clip
clutch
coach
coalesce
coddle
code
coerce
collaborate

Vivid Verbs

Word bank | C (continued)

collapse
collar
collate
collect
collide
collude
combat
combine
comfort
command
commandeer
commence
comment
communicate
compare
compete
compile
complain
complete
complicate
compose
compress
compute
conceive
concentrate
conceptualize
conciliate
conclude
concoct
concur
condense
conduct
confer
confess
confide
confine
confirm
conjecture
connect
conquer
conserve
consider
consolidate
constitute
constrain
construct
construe
consult
contact
continue
contort
contract
contradict
contrast
contribute
control
converge
convert
convey
convince
cooperate
coordinate
copy
corner
correct
correlate
correspond
corroborate
counsel
count
crab
cram
crash
crawl
create
creep
cripple
critique
croon
crouch
cruise
crush
cultivate
customize

Vivid Verbs

Word bank | D

dance	depart	dig
dart	depict	diminish
dash	deploy	direct
dawdle	deposit	disagree
deal	depreciate	disarm
debase	derive	discard
debate	descend	discharge
debug	describe	disclose
decide	desecrate	discover
deck	design	discriminate
declare	designate	discuss
decline	destroy	dismiss
decode	detail	dispatch
decrease	detect	disperse
dedicate	deter	display
deduce	deteriorate	disprove
defend	determine	disrupt
defer	develop	dissect
define	deviate	disseminate
deflect	devise	dissociate
deify	devote	dissolve
delegate	devour	distinguish
delineate	diagnose	distribute
deliver	diagram	disturb
demand	dictate	ditch
demonstrate	differ	dive
denounce	differentiate	diverge
deny	diffuse	diversify

Vivid Verbs

Word bank | D (continued)

divert
divide
divulge
document
dodge
dominate
dope
douse
draft
drag
drain
dramatize
drape
drawl
dress
dribble
drift
drill
drink
drip
drive
drone
drool
drop
drove
drown
drug
duel
dunk
duplicate
dwell

Word bank | E

earn
ease
edge
edify
edit
educate
effect
eject
elaborate
elect
elevate
elicit
eliminate
elongate
elope
elucidate
elude
emanate
embody
emerge
emit
emphasize
employ
enable
encapsulate
encompass
encourage
end
endure
enforce
engage
engender
engineer
engorge
enhance
enjoin
enlarge
enlighten
enlist
enrage
enrapture
enrich
ensnare
ensure
entail

Vivid Verbs

Word bank | E (continued)

enter
entertain
entreat
enumerate
enunciate
equip
eradicate
err
erupt
escalate
escape
escort
establish
estimate
evacuate
evade
evaluate
evaporate
evict
evidence
evolve
exacerbate
examine
except
exchange
excite
exclaim
exclude
execute
exemplify
exercise
exert
exhale
exhibit
exist
exit
expand
expedite
expel
experience
experiment
explain
explode
exploit
explore
expose
express
extend
extract
extrapolate
extricate
exude

Word bank | F

fabricate
facilitate
fade
fail
fake
fall
falsify
falter
familiarize
fan
fashion
fast
father
fear
feature
feed
feel
fend
fetch
fight
filch
file
fill
filter

Vivid Verbs

Word bank | F (continued)

finalize
finance
find
fine tune
finger
finish
fit
fix
flag
flap
flash
flatten
flatter
flaunt
flay
flee
flick
flinch
fling
flip
flirt
flit
float
flog
flounder
flout
flow
flung
flush
flutter
fly
focus
follow
fondle
forage
force
forecast
foretold
form
formulate
fortify
foster
found
frame
freak out
fritter
frown
fulfill
fumble
fumed
fund
furnish
furrow
further
fuse

Word bank | G

gain
gallop
gather
gauge
gaze
generalize
generate
gesture
giggle
give
give rise (to)
glance
glide
glorify
gnaw
goad
gossip
gouge
govern
grab
grade

Vivid Verbs

Word bank | G (continued)

grant
grapple
grasp
graze
greet
grin
grind
grip
gripe
grope
group
grow
growl
grunt
guide
gush
gyrate

Word bank | H

hack
hail
hammer
hamper
handle
hang
harangue
harass
hasten
haul
head
heave
hedge
held
help
hesitate
hide
highlight
hightail
hijack
hike
hinder
hire
hit
hitch
hobble
hoist
hold
host
hover
humble
hunch
hurdle
hurl
hurry
hurtle
hustle
hypnotize
hypothesize

Vivid Verbs

Word bank | 1

identify
ignore
illuminate
illustrate
imagine
imitate
immobilize
impact
impair
impart
impeach
impede
implement
implicate
imply
import
impress
improve
improvise
inch
incline
include
incorporate
increase
incriminate
index
indicate
indict
individualize
induce
infer
inflict
influence
inform
initialize
initiate
inject
injure
innovate
input
inquire
insert
insist
inspect
inspire
install
instigate
institute
instruct
insure
integrate
interact (with)
interchange
interface
interlock
interpret
interrupt
intersect
intervene
interview
introduce
invade
invent
inventory
invert
investigate
invoke
involve
isolate
itemize

Vivid Verbs

Word bank | J

jab
jam
jar
jaunt
jeer
jerk
jest
jiggle
jimmy
jingle
jog
join
jolt
jostle
journey
judge
juggle
jump
justify
jut

Word bank | K

kick
kidnap
kill
kneel
knife

Word bank | L

label
lag
lambaste
lash
laugh
launch
lead
lean
leap
learn
lecture
level
license
lick
lie
lighten
limit
limp
linger
link
liquidate
list
listen
litigate
lob
lobby
localize
locate
lodge
log
loiter
lollygag
loosen
lose
lumber
lunge
lurch

Vivid Verbs

Word bank | M

maim	measure	model
maintain	mechanize	moderate
manage	meddle	modernize
mangle	mediate	modify
manifest	mention	monitor
manipulate	mentor	mosey
manufacture	merge	mother
map	message	motivate
march	methodize	mourn
mark	migrate	mumble
market	mimic	murder
massage	mingle	murmur
master	minimize	muse
maul	mix	muster
maximize	moan	mutilate
mean	mobilize	mutter
meander	mock	

Word bank | N

nab	need	note
nag	needle	notify
nail	negate	nudge
narrate	negotiate	nullify
navigate	nick	nurse
necessitate	nip	nurture

Vivid Verbs

Word bank | O

object
obliterate
obscure
observe
obstruct
obtain
occupy
occur
offer
officiate
offset
omit
operate
optimize
orate
orchestrate
order
organize
orient
originate
outline
overcome
overhaul
overlap
overlie
oversee
overstate
overthrow

Word bank | P

pack
package
paddle
page
pander
panic
parachute
parade
paralyze
park
parry
participate
party
pass
pat
patrol
patronize
pause
paw
peek
peel
peep
pelt
penetrate
perceive
perch
perfect
perform
permeate
persist
personify
persuade
petition
photograph
pick
picket
pile
pilfer
pilot
pin
pinch
pioneer
pirate
pitch
placate

Vivid Verbs

Word bank | P (continued)

place
plague
plan
plead
plod
plot
plow
pluck
plummet
plunge
pocket
point out
poke
polish
pore
possess
postulate
pounce
pout
practice
prance
pray
precede
precipitate
predict
preen
prefer
prepare
prescribe
present
preserve
preside
presume
prevail
prevent
primp
print
prioritize
probe
proceed
process
proclaimed
procrastinate
prod
produce
profess
profit
program
progress
project
promise
promote
prompt
proofread
propel
propose
protect
prove
provide
provoke
prowl
pry
publicize
publish
pull
pummel
pump
punch
purchase
purify
purloin
pursue
push

Vivid Verbs

Word bank | Q

quack	query	quit
quake	question	quiver
qualify	quicken	quiz
quantify	quip	quote

Word bank | R

race	receive	refine
radiate	reciprocate	reflect
raid	reclaim	refute
raise	recline	regain
rally	recognize	regard
ram	recoil	register
range	recommend	regulate
rank	reconcile	rehabilitate
ransack	reconstruct	reinforce
rant	record	reiterate
rate	recoup	reject
rattle	recreate	rejoice
ravage	recruit	rejoin
rave	rectify	relate
reach	redact	relax
read	redeem	release
realize	redefine	relent
reason	reduce	rely
reassure	reel	remediate
rebuff	refer	remodel
recall	reference	remonstrate

Vivid Verbs

Word bank | R (continued)

remove
render
renew
renounce
reorganize
repair
repeat
repel
replace
replicate
reply
report
represent
reproduce
repulse
request
require
research
resemble
reserve
resign
resist
resolve
respond
restate
restore
restrict
result in
resume
retain
retaliate
retort
retreat
retrieve
return
revamp
reveal
review
revise
revitalize
revolve
ride
ridicule
rip
rise
risk
roam
roar
roared
rob
rock
roll
rotate
route
rove
rub
rule
run
rupture
rush

Word bank | S

sail
salute
salvage
sample
sanction
sap
sashay
satisfy
saturate
saunter
save
saw
scale
scamper
scan
scare
scatter
scavenge

Vivid Verbs

Word bank | S (continued)

schedule
scoff
scold
scoop
scoot
score
scour
scout
scramble
scrape
scrawl
scream
screen
screw
script
scrub
scruff
scrutinize
scuff
scuffle
sculpt
scurry
scuttle
seal
search
secure
seduce
seek
seep
segment
seize
select
sell
send
sense
separate
serve
service
settle
sever
sew
shake
shanghai
shape
share
sharpen
shave
shear
shell
shield
shift
shiver
shock
shoot
shorten
shout
shove
shove off
shovel
show
shriek
shrink
shuffle
shun
shut
sidestep
sigh
signal
signify
simplify
simulate
single out
sink
sip
sit
situate
size
sizzle
sketch
skid
skim
skip
skirt
slacken
slam
slap
slash

Vivid Verbs

Word bank | S (continued)

slay
slide
slink
slither
slop
slow
slug
smack
smash
smear
smell
smuggle
snake
snap
snare
snarl
snatch
sneak
sneer
snicker
sniff
snitch
snivel
snoop
snort
snot
snub
snuff
snuggle
soak
soar
sob
sock
soil
solicit
solidify
solve
soothe
sort
speak
spear
spearhead
specialize
specify
speculate
speed
spell
spike
spill
spin
splatter
splice
split
splurge
spot
spray
spread
spring
sprint
spur
spurn
sputter
sputtered
spy
squander
squash
squat
squeak
squelch
squint
squirm
stabilize
stack
stage
stagger
stalk
stammer
stamp
stand
standardize
start
startle
state
steal
steer
stem from
step

Vivid Verbs

Word bank | S (continued)

stick
stiffen
stifle
stimulate
stipulate
stitch
stomp
stop
storm
straighten
strangle
strap
strategize
stray
streak
streamline
strengthen
stress
stride
strike
strip
stroll
structure
struggle
strut
stub
study
stuff
stumble
stun
stutter
subdue
subject
submerge
submit
substantiate
substitute
succeed
suck
suffer
suggest
sum up
summarize
summon
superimpose
superpose
supervise
supply
support
suppress
surmise
surpass
surrender
surround
survey
suspend
sustain
swagger
swallow
swamp
swap
sway
swear
swerve
swim
swindle
swing
swipe
switch
swoop
symbolize
sympathize
synthesize
systematize

Vivid Verbs

Word bank | T

tabulate
tackle
tail
tailor
taint
take
take flight
take leave
take off
take place
tap
target
taste
taunt
teach
tear
tease
telephone
tempt
tend
terminate
terrorize
test
testify
theorize
thrash
thread
threaten
throw
thrust
thwart
tickle
tie
tilt
time
tip
tip-toe
toddle
tolerate
tool
torment
torque
toss
totter
touch
tour
tout
trace
track
trade
train
trample
transcribe
transect
transfer
transform
translate
transmit
transport
transpose
trap
travel
traverse
tread
treat
trek
trend
trickle
trigger
trip
triple
triumph
tromp
trot
troubleshoot
trudge
trust
try
tuck
tug
tumble
turn
tutor
twirl

Vivid Verbs

Word bank | T (continued)

twist
twitch
type
tyrannize

Word bank | U

uncover
undergo
underlie
underline
undermine
underscore
understand
understate
undertake
undo
undress
unfold
unify
unite
untangle
unveil
unwind
update
upgrade
uphold
urge
use
usher
utilize
utter

Word bank | V

vacate
validate
value
vamoose
vanish
vanquish
vary
vault
vent
verify
view
vindicate
violate
visit
visualize
vitalize
volunteer
vow

Vivid Verbs

Word bank | W

waddle	weep	wiggle
wade	weigh	win
wail	whack	withdraw
waltz	whimper	withstand
wander	whine	witness
ward	whip	wobble
warn	whirl	woo
watch	whisk	work
wave	whisper	wreck
weave	whistle	wrench
wedge	whitewash	wrestle
weed	wield	write

Word bank | Y

yank	yelp
yell	yield

Word bank | Z

zap	zip	zoom

Vivid Verbs

Practice | your turn

1. Replace went in a calm scene and in a tense scene.

2. Revise "The author says the characters are different" using a more precise analytical verb.

3. Pick five unfamiliar verbs from the bank and write accurate sentences.

Vivid Verbs

Sample answers | check after trying

Writing tasks can have more than one strong answer. Use these models and checks to review your work.

1

Calm: wandered or strolled. Tense: rushed or darted, if supported by context.

2

Possible revision: The author contrasts the characters' responses to failure.

3

Check definition, tense, object and tone. Do not choose a verb only because it sounds impressive.

Source & editing note

Vivid Verbs to Enhance Writing.pdf | 6 supplied pages.

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Exact repeated list entries were consolidated and obvious extraction/spelling errors repaired. Alternatives may differ in meaning, grammar or tone.

Word Choice & Revision

Concept

Revise vague, inflated or unsuitable wording so the reader can understand exactly what you mean.

Review, not a ban

The source lists words to avoid in formal essays. Treat them as prompts to check purpose and precision, not forbidden words in every genre.

First person

I is useful in reflection and personal narrative. Follow the assignment for other forms.

Dialogue tags

Said is often clear and unobtrusive. Alternatives should accurately name speech; a person cannot literally "grin" a sentence.

Intensifiers

Instead of automatically replacing very, consider a precise adjective or a concrete detail.

Absolute claims

Words such as always and everyone need evidence. Qualify a claim when appropriate.

Grammar

Write could have or could've, not could of. Use used to for a past habit; after did/didn't, use use to.

Word Choice & Revision

Example 1 | original model

Revise: Everyone thinks the room is really nice.

Solution / why it works

1. Problem: everyone is unsupported, really adds little, and nice is vague.

2. Revision: The room's wide desks and bright windows make it comfortable for reading.

3. The revision gives observable features instead of an unsupported universal claim.

Word bank | Words to review in formal writing

a bit	cheap	get
a lot	completely	go
about	could of	goes
absolutely	crap	going
all	did	gone
almost	does	gonna
always	duh	good
amazing	every	got
anyway	everybody	gotta
anyways	everyone	great
awesome	everything	gross
bad	feel	hang out
barely	finally	hate
believe	fine	have got
big	fun	here are
bummed	funny	hopefully

Word Choice & Revision

Word bank | Words to review in formal writing (continued)

how come
I
just
kind of
kinda
like
literally
loser
lots
luv
me
merely
my
myself
need
never
nice
not
of course
often
OK or okay
only
perfect
pissed
pretty
psycho
really
replied
said
screw up
short
small
so
some
sort of
stuff
stupid
sucks
tall
that
the end
then
thing
think
totally
use to
used to
very
wanna
well
went
whatever
wonderful
yah
yeah
you
your

Word bank | Speech / reporting verbs

acknowledged
added
addressed
admitted
admonished
advised
agreed
alleged
allowed
announced
answered
approved
argued
asked
assented
asserted
assumed
assured
attested
avowed
babbled

Word Choice & Revision

Word bank | Speech / reporting verbs (continued)

bantered
bargained
began
begged
bellowed
blurted
boasted
called
cautioned
chattered
chided
claimed
commanded
commented
complained
confessed
confided
continued
contradicted
countered
cried
debated
decided
declared
demanded
denied
denounced
described
dictated
directed
disclosed
disrupted
divulged
drawled
droned
elaborated
emphasized
enjoined
entreated
enunciated
estimated
explained
exposed
expressed
faltered
feared
foretold
fumed
gasped
giggled
glared
grinned
growled
grunted
gushed
held
hissed
implied
indicated
inferred
insisted
instructed
interrupted
itemized
joked
lamented
laughed
lectured
lied
maintained
mentioned
mimicked
moaned
mumbled
murmured
mused
muttered
nagged
narrated
noted
notified
objected
observed
orated
ordered
petitioned
pleaded

Word Choice & Revision

Word bank | Speech / reporting verbs (continued)

pled
pointed out
prayed
predicted
proclaimed
professed
prompted
ranted
reassured
rebuked
reciprocated
refuted
related
remonstrated
repeated
replied
responded
restated
resumed
retorted
returned
revealed
roared
ruled
sanctioned
scoffed
scolded
screamed
shouted
shrieked
sighed
snapped
sneered
snorted
snubbed
sobbed
spoke
sputtered
stammered
stated
stipulated
stormed
stressed
stuttered
suggested
taunted
teased
thought
threatened
told
urged
uttered
ventured
vowed
wailed
warned
whimpered
whispered
wondered
yelled

Word bank | Alternatives to very (check meaning)

abnormally
astonishingly
bitterly
chiefly
curiously
deeply
especially
exceedingly
extraordinarily
fully
generally
hugely
immeasurably
increasingly
incredibly
infinitely
intensely
mightily

Word Choice & Revision

Word bank | Alternatives to very (check meaning) (continued)

mildly
normally
oddly
ordinarily
particularly
powerfully
rarely
regularly
remarkably
richly
scarcely
severely
shockingly
slightly
strangely
strongly
surely
surprisingly
truly
uncommonly
universally
unusually

Word bank | Positive qualities

acceptable
adequate
advantageous
appropriate
beneficial
benevolent
bright
capable
careful
clever
considerable
decent
delightful
enjoyable
excellent
exceptional
expert
first-class
first-rate
fit
glowing
healthy
helpful
high-quality
lovely
pleasant
polite
reliable
respectable
select
skilled
sound
sufficient
superior
thriving
top
trustworthy
upright
upstanding
virtuous
worthy

Word Choice & Revision

Word bank | Humour & enjoyment

amusing	exciting	pleasure
comical	hilarious	quaint
curious	humorous	strange
droll	joyful	unusual
enjoyable	odd	weird
enjoyment	peculiar	witty
entertaining	pleasurable	

Word bank | Sadness

bitter	forlorn	miserable
blue	gloomy	moved
cheerless	glum	pensive
dejected	grief-stricken	regretful
depressing	heartbreaking	somber
despondent	heart rending	sorrowful
disappointing	heavy-hearted	sorry
distressing	melancholy	wistful

Word bank | Negative qualities

abominable	cruel	disagreeable
abysmal	debauched	displeasing
appalling	defective	distressing
atrocious	deleterious	dreadful
awful	deplorable	evil
base	depraved	fearful
black	destructive	foul
corrupt	detrimental	frightful

Word Choice & Revision

Word bank | Negative qualities (continued)

harmful
hopeless
horrid
hurtful
ill
immoral
impaired
inauspicious
incompetent
inferior
iniquitous
injurious
lamentable
lousy
mediocre
misbehaving
mischievous
nasty
naughty
negative
offensive
painful
peccant
pitiful
poor
putrid
reprobate
rotten
sinful
sorry
terrible
troublesome
uncongenial
unfavorable
unpleasant
unpropitious
unsatisfactory
unskilled
unspeakable
unsympathetic
vicious
vile
villainous
wicked
wrong

Word bank | Amount & frequency

abundance
common
considerable
consistently
countless
diverse
few
frequently
habitually
hardly
infrequently
innumerable
meager
meagre
minority
myriad
numerous
occasionally
paltry
plenty
prevalent
profuse
rarely
repeatedly
scant
scarcely
seldom
several
slight
smatter
sparse
sporadic
sprinkling

Word Choice & Revision

Practice | your turn

1. Revise "The thing was very bad" by naming the object and its exact problem.

2. Write a sentence where said is the best choice, and one where whispered is justified.

3. Find one absolute claim in your writing and qualify it or add evidence.

Word Choice & Revision

Sample answers | check after trying

Writing tasks can have more than one strong answer. Use these models and checks to review your work.

1

Possible revision: The chair's cracked backrest made it unsafe to use.

2

Said can be neutral; whispered specifically indicates low-volume speech.

3

Replace unsupported everyone with a defensible group, or support the claim with relevant evidence.

Source & editing note

Words to Avoid to Improve Word Choice in Writing.pdf | 3 supplied pages.

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Writing Challenges

Concept

A challenge is the final thought that leaves the reader considering the meaning or implications of an essay.

Purpose

Give the reader a reason to keep thinking after the conclusion.

Forms

A thoughtful question, strong statement, vivid image, relevant quotation, warning, suggestion or call to action.

Earn the ending

The final thought should follow from the argument already developed.

Proportion

Avoid dramatic warnings or sweeping claims that the essay has not supported.

Placement

Usually the last sentence of the whole essay, after the main ideas have been brought together.

Writing Challenges

Example 1 | original model

End an essay proposing a shared classroom bookshelf.

Solution / why it works

1. Question: What might change if every student could recommend a book to the next reader?

2. Action: Start with one shelf, then invite each class to contribute a recommendation.

3. Why these work: both grow from the proposal and give the reader a concrete next thought.

Writing Challenges

Practice | your turn

1. Write a rhetorical question ending for an essay about reducing classroom waste.

2. Write an action ending for the same essay.

3. Choose the better ending for your intended audience and explain why.

Writing Challenges

Sample answers | check after trying

Writing tasks can have more than one strong answer. Use these models and checks to review your work.

1

Possible question: What could our classroom save by using each page twice?

2

Possible action: Place a scrap-paper tray beside the printer and use it for first drafts.

3

Choose the ending that fits the essay's evidence and audience; neither form is always better.

Source & editing note

Writing Challenges.pdf | 1 supplied pages.

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Concluding Sentences

Concept

A concluding sentence closes a paragraph by bringing its main point together. It should make the paragraph feel complete.

Restate, don't copy

Rephrase the topic sentence or synthesize the supporting details.

No new point

Save a new argument or unexplained evidence for another paragraph.

Optional transition

Therefore or overall can help, but a clear connection matters more than a stock phrase.

Paragraph vs essay

A paragraph close resolves one point; an essay conclusion synthesizes the whole argument.

Concluding Sentences

Example 1 | original model

Close this paragraph: A planner makes deadlines visible. It collects due dates and breaks projects into smaller steps.

Solution / why it works

1. Weak ending: Planners come in many colours.

2. Better ending: By making tasks visible, a planner turns a distant deadline into manageable steps.

3. Why it works: it connects the details to the main point without adding an unrelated topic.

Concluding Sentences

One paragraph, one main point

Topic sentence

State the paragraph's central point.

↓

Support

Give relevant examples, facts or textual evidence.

↓

Explanation

Show how the support develops the point.

↓

Concluding sentence

Bring the point together or create a logical link forward.

Concluding Sentences

Practice | your turn

1. Write a closing sentence for a paragraph about the benefits of a quiet reading space.

2. Revise a conclusion that simply repeats your topic sentence word for word.

3. Check whether the last sentence introduces a new point.

Concluding Sentences

Sample answers | check after trying

Writing tasks can have more than one strong answer. Use these models and checks to review your work.

1

Possible close: Together, fewer interruptions and a predictable routine make sustained reading easier.

2

Keep the central idea but synthesize its supporting reasons in new wording.

3

If it introduces a new claim, develop that claim elsewhere or remove it.

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Writing Focus Statements

Concept

A focus statement introduces the general topic and useful context between the opening hook and the specific thesis.

Topic

The broad subject: school gardens.

Focus statement

A complete sentence that orients the reader to that topic.

Thesis statement

The specific claim the essay will develop and support.

Narrowing

Move from interest → context → claim. Each sentence should connect naturally to the next.

Writing Focus Statements

Example 1 | original model

Build an introduction about a school garden.

Solution / why it works

1. Hook: An unused patch of soil can become a classroom.
2. Focus: School gardens give students a space to study plants through direct observation.
3. Thesis: Our school should create a small garden because it would support science lessons and shared responsibility.
4. The focus provides context; the thesis makes the proposal and previews its reasons.

Writing Focus Statements

Opening map | broad to specific

Hook

Create interest in the subject.

↓

Focus / context

Orient the reader and connect the opening to the topic.

↓

Thesis

State the specific claim or controlling idea.

Writing Focus Statements

Practice planner | introduction

Topic / audience / purpose:

Hook option A:

Hook option B:

Focus statement / bridge:

Thesis:

Writing Focus Statements

Practice | your turn

1. Choose a topic and write one focus statement without arguing your position yet.

2. Add a thesis that takes a specific position on that topic.

3. Read the pair aloud. Remove repeated wording and fill any logical gap.

Writing Focus Statements

Sample answers | check after trying

Writing tasks can have more than one strong answer. Use these models and checks to review your work.

1

For public libraries: Public libraries provide shared spaces for reading, research and community programs.

2

Possible thesis: The local library should extend its evening hours so students can use its study spaces after activities.

3

A reader should understand the topic before encountering your claim.

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Writing Grabbers

Concept

A grabber, or hook, invites the reader into the topic. The best opening creates interest that the rest of the essay can fulfil.

Available forms

A question, strong statement, dramatic exclamation, quotation, statistic, figure of speech or brief story.

Relevance

The opening must connect to the actual subject and purpose.

Bridge

Follow the hook with context that leads to the thesis.

Credibility

Verify facts and statistics. Attribute quotations accurately; never invent a source.

Restraint

Avoid empty exaggeration or a dramatic opening that the essay cannot support.

Writing Grabbers

Example 1 | original model

Open an essay about a lost library book.

Solution / why it works

1. Mini-story hook: I found the overdue book beneath a stack of unfinished plans.
2. Bridge: Returning it forced me to notice how often I postponed small responsibilities.
3. Why it works: the concrete image introduces the reflection that follows.

Example 2 | original model

Try a different hook for the same topic.

Solution / why it works

1. Question: Why can a five-minute task remain unfinished for weeks?
2. The question opens the issue of procrastination without claiming an invented statistic.

Writing Grabbers

Opening map | broad to specific

Hook

Create interest in the subject.

↓

Focus / context

Orient the reader and connect the opening to the topic.

↓

Thesis

State the specific claim or controlling idea.

Writing Grabbers

Practice planner | introduction

Topic / audience / purpose:

Hook option A:

Hook option B:

Focus statement / bridge:

Thesis:

Writing Grabbers

Practice | your turn

1. Write two hooks for the same topic using different forms.

2. Write a bridge from each hook to your topic.

3. Choose the hook that best fits the audience and explain your choice.

Writing Grabbers

Sample answers | check after trying

Writing tasks can have more than one strong answer. Use these models and checks to review your work.

1

Try a short scene and a relevant question, or a strong statement and a comparison.

2

The bridge should make the connection visible; do not jump to an unrelated claim.

3

Prefer a specific, honest opening that prepares the reader for the essay you will actually write.

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Rhetorical & Stylistic Devices

Concept

A device is a deliberate language choice. Explain what it emphasizes, how it shapes a response, and why it suits the purpose.

Effect depends on context

A device may clarify, persuade, entertain, create rhythm or draw attention. Avoid memorizing one fixed effect.

Analysis pattern

Device + exact detail + specific effect + connection to purpose.

Ethos / pathos / logos

Additional guide: credibility, emotional appeal and reasoning. A device may support more than one appeal.

Precision

Identify the actual pattern. Repeated words at the start are anaphora; repeated conjunctions are polysyndeton.

Example 1 | original model

Original sentence: "We need time to listen, time to question, time to change."

Solution / why it works

1. Pattern: repeated "time to" at the start of successive phrases = anaphora.
2. Structure: the three phrases use matching grammar = parallelism.
3. Effect: the repetition makes a three-part call to action memorable and gives equal weight to each step.

Rhetorical & Stylistic Devices

Example 2 | original model

Compare: “We packed, ran, waited.” / “We packed and ran and waited.”

Solution / why it works

1. First: asyndeton omits conjunctions and can create a brisk, compressed pace.

2. Second: polysyndeton repeats and, giving each action emphasis and potentially slowing the sequence.

3. The actual effect depends on the surrounding passage and how it is read.

Rhetorical & Stylistic Devices

Reference | Repetition, balance & arrangement

Alliteration

Repeated initial consonant sounds: bright blue banners.

Assonance

Repeated vowel sounds: pale rain.

Anaphora

Repeated openings: We listen. We learn. We act.

Antimetabole

Words repeat in reverse order: We shape habits; habits shape us.

Antithesis

Balanced contrast: A quiet voice can carry a powerful message.

Parallelism

Matching grammar for related ideas: to read, to question, to revise.

Asyndeton

Conjunctions are omitted: She read, questioned, revised.

Polysyndeton

Conjunctions are repeated: She read and questioned and revised.

Periodic sentence

The main clause arrives near the end: After the noise faded and the doors closed, she spoke.

Rhetorical & Stylistic Devices

Juxtaposition

Things placed close together invite comparison: a new tower beside a ruined cottage.

Closing by return

An ending returns to an opening image or idea.

Framing words

Signals mark the structure or relationship of ideas: first, moreover, therefore.

Flow

Coherence and continuity among sentences and paragraphs.

Zeugma

One word links multiple elements, sometimes in different senses: She lost her keys and her patience.

Rhetorical & Stylistic Devices

Reference | Comparison, association & imagery

Allusion

A reference relies on the audience recognizing another text, event or tradition.

Analogy

A comparison explains an unfamiliar idea through a more familiar relationship.

Simile

A comparison using like or as: the crowd moved like a tide.

Metaphor

A non-literal comparison: the crowd was a tide.

Personification

Human qualities are given to non-human things: the alarm protested.

Figurative language

Language extends beyond literal meaning through techniques such as metaphor or hyperbole.

Imagery

Sensory language evokes sight, sound, touch, taste or smell.

Symbol

Something represents a meaning beyond its literal role, supported by context.

Metonymy

An associated thing substitutes for another: the bench for the judiciary.

Rhetorical & Stylistic Devices

Synecdoche

A part substitutes for a whole: wheels for a car.

Connotation

Emotional or cultural associations beyond a word's denotation.

Euphemism

A milder expression softens a difficult subject: passed away for died.

Oxymoron

Apparently contradictory terms together: a familiar stranger.

Hyperbole

Deliberate exaggeration: I have a mountain of homework.

Understatement

Deliberately reduced emphasis: a shattered vase is "a little damaged."

Rhetorical & Stylistic Devices

Reference | Voice, persuasion & audience

Anecdote

A short incident illustrates a point or creates a personal connection.

Colloquialism

Conversational wording such as "a bit"; suitable register depends on audience.

Hortative sentence

Urges or encourages action: Let us give everyone a chance to speak.

Imperative sentence

Commands or requests: Read the final paragraph again.

Rhetorical question

A question used for effect or thought rather than a literal answer.

Irony

A meaningful gap between literal wording and intention, expectation and outcome, or audience and character knowledge.

Satire

Uses humour, irony or exaggeration to criticize faults or institutions.

Tone

The speaker's or writer's attitude toward the subject or audience.

Rhetorical & Stylistic Devices

Word bank | Tone vocabulary

Satiric	Disdainful	Compassionate
Whimsical	Pedantic	Impartial
Dramatic	Indignant	Pretentious
Learned	Bantering	Vibrant
Informative	Flippant	Sentimental
Sombre	Patronizing	Moralistic
Urgent	Mock-serious	Taunting
Confident	Benevolent	Angry
Objective	Burlesque	Turgid
Diffident	Fanciful	Insolent
Ironic	Detached	Condescending
Didactic	Cynical	Sympathetic
Petty	Scornful	Inflammatory
Factual	Effusive	Candid
Restrained	Colloquial	

Rhetorical & Stylistic Devices

Practice | your turn

1. Identify the device: “She lost her keys and her patience.”

2. Write one example of antithesis using parallel grammar.

3. Find a device in your class reading and explain its specific effect in two sentences.

Rhetorical & Stylistic Devices

Sample answers | check after trying

Writing tasks can have more than one strong answer. Use these models and checks to review your work.

1

Zeugma: lost links a literal object (keys) and an abstract state (patience).

2

Possible example: We can build bridges, or we can build barriers. The parallel clauses sharpen the contrast.

3

Avoid "it interests the reader" alone. Explain what is emphasized and how it supports the passage's purpose.

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